hijackers. But we've all decided to wait and hear the outcome of the Israeli cabinet meeting.

June 17

Day started with what's getting to be my regular early call from Bud M [McFarlane]. Nabih Berri has taken the hostages from the hijackers and has them some place in West Beirut.

His price is release of the 760 Shiites held by Israel. Israel is publicly saying they will, but the U.S. at the highest level of govt, must ask them to do it. This of course means that me—not they, would be violating our policy of not negotiating with terrorists. To do so, of course, negotiate with terrorists, is to encourage more terrorism. . . .

June 18

Today Berri released three of the hostages, one was a Greek citizen with an American girl friend and the third an 18 year old Armenian. . . . Tonight's press conference went well and I had to walk a tight rope all the way, what with questions about the hijacking . . . we had the biggest phone and telegram response yet. . . . about 74 per cent favorable.

June 19

Only thing new on hijacking was a plane side interview with plane captain through the pilot's window. He confirmed that the three crew members were only ones on plane along with Shiite guards. That captain is quite a guy, absolutely unruffled . . .

June 20

We finally settled on availing ourselves of the generous proposal by Algeria to ask that the hostages be turned over to them. A face saver for Nabih Berri.